

8.3.2 Phishing in the sea

Phishing attacks involve extracting vital information from the quarry using social engineering by masquerading as a trustworthy entity. To stop those credit card numbers from leaking out, here is a list of tools worth checking out:

- Open Phishing Database project (<http://opdb.berlios.de/>): This project maintains an open database of phishing sites and provides browser utilities for using those. FireFish for Mozilla Firefox is one such.
- SpoofStick (www.spoofstick.com/): No word on whether it is open source or not, but you can take a quick peek at the sources of the Firefox extension.
- SpoofGuard (<http://crypto.stanford.edu/SpoofGuard/>): It is targeted towards both Internet Explorer and Mozilla Firefox users. A set of weights is defined which can be changed any-time. These weights are assigned to different activities that add up to detect spoofing attempts. The Firefox version is available as an extension.

8.4 Firewalls

A firewall is analogous to digging a deep moat around your castle to protect yourself from foes. It can be either hardware- or software-based, and makes sure that the traffic that flows through the network complies with the local security policy. This section will lead you through how to use open source tools for setting up such barriers and secure your computer to a good extent from the Stygian realms of the Internet.

8.4.1 Affaire d'honneur

Indeed, this is the battle for honour, wherein your computer is the artefact, the town centre to be protected. We start by securing a typical Windows box.

8.4.1.1 WIPFW

WIPFW for Windows is based on the popular IPFW1 for the